

future and you needn't worry about a quick turnaround (more on how to find these prices later).

2) **Choose a destination and then look for flights:** While we dream of a summer vacation in Mauritius, more often the origins of wanderlust occur via Instagram, magazines or in-person recommendations. When making travel plans at a whim, the flight expenses reflect average prices and not discounted prices.

What to do instead: Have a list of destinations in your dream list. As you search for prices, choose the destination that offers discounted flights during a period of your convenience (don't worry discounts occur more often - once in 2 weeks at-least). Instead of approaching travel with one destination in mind, having options will give you leverage to reduce the biggest expense: flights.

3) **Make plans when we are almost near burnout:** Much like the advice to not go to the supermarket when we're hungry, making travel plans when we're near exhaustion, makes high expenditure acceptable to us. This means most of our savings are wiped out and the next trip will take at-least another 2 years where we may get into the same cycle again.

What to do instead: If you have 40k in savings, finish this trip for 30-33k and start accumulating for next trip (more on how to set this up, shortly).

Finding Cheap Flights

Before we dive into the nitty-gritty there are the two kind of fares for cheap flights:

1. **Mistake fares:** Occur rarely and the fares are 70-80% discounted because someone made a fat-finger mistake, the XML connectivity malfunctioned or the airline released a 2-hour promo to fill-up base revenue. Here's an example [\[10\]](#) :

Exhibit #1